ALEXANDER JAMES RICHARDSON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Principal Engineer with 12 years of experience building and scaling distributed systems at high-growth tech companies. I've led architecture decisions that reduced infrastructure costs by millions while improving system reliability from 98% to 99.99% uptime. My background spans backend services, cloud infrastructure, and mentoring engineering teams through complex technical transitions. I'm particularly interested in problems involving data consistency, system observability, and building teams that ship reliable software.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Principal Engineer

TechCore Solutions Ltd

Leeds, United Kingdom

techcoresolutions.io

March 2021 - Present

Led the architecture and delivery of a microservices platform serving 50 million daily requests across Europe, establishing patterns and standards adopted by 25+ engineers across three teams. Implemented comprehensive observability using Prometheus and ELK stack, reducing mean time to resolution for incidents from 45 minutes to 8 minutes. Mentored 8 senior engineers and established a quarterly architecture review process that improved code quality metrics and reduced production defects by 34% year-on-year. Drove migration from monolithic PostgreSQL to a distributed event-sourcing architecture, managing data consistency across services and reducing query latency from 850ms to 120ms for critical user paths.

Senior Staff Engineer

CloudVault Technologies

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

cloudvault.tech

September 2018 - February 2021

Designed and implemented a Kubernetes platform supporting 40+ microservices and 200+ containerized applications, reducing deployment time from 2 hours to 12 minutes. Established SRE practices including runbooks, alert tuning, and chaos engineering experiments that improved system reliability metrics across all services. Built a team of 6 platform engineers and delegated architecture ownership, enabling faster decision-making and increased team autonomy. Managed infrastructure costs totalling GBP 2.8 million annually and negotiated cloud contracts with AWS and GCP, securing 28% cost savings without impacting performance.

Senior Software Engineer

DataStream Solutions

Manchester, United Kingdom

datastream-solutions.co

June 2015 - August 2018

Developed high-throughput data processing pipelines using Apache Kafka and Spark, handling 500+ million events daily with 99.95% delivery guarantees. Led the adoption of Go across the backend team of 12 engineers, establishing coding standards, CI/CD practices, and resulting in 40% faster service deployment times. Implemented distributed tracing infrastructure using Jaeger, enabling engineers to quickly diagnose performance issues in a system of 60+ interconnected services. Reduced database query costs by GBP 400k annually through query optimization, indexing strategies, and caching layer implementation using Redis.

EDUCATION

University of Leeds

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science with First Class Honours

Leeds, United Kingdom

Graduated: June 2012

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Go, Python, Java, SQL, Bash, TypeScript

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, RDS, ECS, Lambda, S3), Google Cloud Platform, Azure

Container Orchestration: Kubernetes, Docker, Helm, Prometheus

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Elasticsearch, DynamoDB, Redis

Message Queues: Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ, AWS SQS

Tools and Frameworks: gRPC, REST APIs, Microservices Architecture, Event Sourcing, CQRS

DevOps: Terraform, CI/CD pipelines, GitHub Actions, ArgoCD, Jenkins

Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Jaeger, DataDog

Software Practices: System Design, Architecture Reviews, Code Review, Mentoring, Technical Leadership

GITHUB REPOSITORIES

github.com/ajrichardson/kafka-golang-consumer - Production-grade Kafka consumer library in Go with offset management and backpressure handling. 450+ stars.

github.com/ajrichardson/distributed-tracing-tutorial - Practical guide to implementing distributed tracing with Jaeger, including Docker Compose setup and Python examples. 320+ stars.

github.com/ajrichardson/kubernetes-cost-optimizer - Tool for analyzing Kubernetes cluster resource utilization and recommending right-sizing changes. 280+ stars.

github.com/ajrichardson/postgres-query-optimizer - Analysis scripts and best practices for optimizing slow PostgreSQL queries in production environments. 210+ stars.